

Python prototype code of a GRASP engine and API

Brian E. Carpenter

brian.e.carpenter@gmail.com

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Table of Contents

Introduction.....	1
API.....	2
Data Structures.....	3
Functions.....	4
Registration functions:.....	6
Discovery function:.....	9
Negotiation functions:.....	10
Synchronization and Flood functions:.....	14
Send/Receive functions.....	17
Utility functions:.....	18
Implementation Notes.....	19
ACP interface.....	21
Discovery Unsolicited Link-Local (DULL).....	21
QUick And Dirty Security for GRASP (QUADS).....	21
Encryption Only.....	21
QUADS Key Infrastructure.....	22
Testing.....	23
Screen shot extracted from the Gray/Briggs ASA test.....	25
GRASP initialisation example:.....	26
Sample negotiation output extracted from the test suite.....	26
Output extracted from the Gray/Briggs ASA test.....	27

Introduction

This note describes a prototype open source implementation of the GeneRic Autonomic Signaling Protocol (GRASP) originally written in Python 3.4, tested up to 3.14.3. It is based on Proposed Standard [RFC8990](#). GRASP is intended for use by Autonomic Service Agents (ASAs). For further background, see Informational [RFC8993](#).

The implementation provides two slightly different versions of the application programming interface (API) for use by ASAs. The principal API is provided by module **graspi.py** and implements Informational [RFC8991](#). A slightly different older version, retained for backwards compatibility, referred to below as the "old API", is provided by the underlying module **grasp.py**.

The code is not guaranteed or validated and is both incomplete and probably wrong. Its main purpose was to help improve the specifications. It can also be used to help test other implementations. Python being an interpreted language, performance is slow.

SECURITY WARNINGS:

- There is no security in the GRASP protocol itself; it relies on an Autonomic Control Plane (ACP) substrate.
- The code assumes that an Autonomic Control Plane (ACP) up on all interfaces or none; does not watch for interface up/down changes.
- By default, the code runs with an elementary ACP that offers no security.
- There is no TLS support.
- Unless layer 2 security is provided, the user is RECOMMENDED to run QUick And Dirty Security (QUADS) for GRASP, which acts as a virtual ACP, protecting all traffic. This is described below (page 21).
- The code optionally supports the DULL security instance described in the GRASP specification. See below (page 21).

LIMITATIONS:

- Only coded for IPv6, no IPv4 support
- FQDN and URI locators are allowed in discovery responses, but otherwise they are not handled at all.
- No code for rapid mode negotiation.
- The relay code is lazy (no rate control).
- There are work-arounds for issues in the Python socket module and Windows socket peculiarities. The code is intended to be portable between Windows (Winsock2) and POSIX environments but YMMV.

This document covers the APIs for use by ASAs, plus implementation and testing.

The latest version of this document, and the code, can be found at

<https://github.com/becarpenter/graspy>.

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API

The approach is procedural in style, i.e. mainly a collection of functions. This is not very Pythonic, i.e. there is no such thing as a GRASP session defined as a Python class. A session is identified by a session handle¹ that the programmer must present to some API functions. To use the API, Python 3 code needs to **import graspi**. This will **import grasp**, which will in turn **import acp**. All three modules must be in the Python path. Code using the old API uses **import grasp**.

¹ previously 'nonce'

Data Structures

Three Python classes are provided by **graspi** (and **grasp**) as follows:

class objective(name)

A Python object of this class holds a GRASP objective. Its attributes are:

- .name Unicode string – the objective's name
- .neg Boolean – True if objective supports negotiation (default False)
- .dry Boolean – True if objective supports dry-run negotiation (default False)
- .synch Boolean – True if objective supports synchronization (default False)
- .loop_count integer – Limit on negotiation steps etc. (default GRASP_DEF_LOOPCT)
- .value any valid Python object – the value of the objective (default None)

An ASA would create a new instance of the EX1 objective thus:

```
new_obj = grasp.objective("EX1")
```

and then set any attributes that it needs to. For most cases, either `neg` or `synch` needs to be `True`; they must not both be `True`. Alternatively, for a dry-run negotiation, `dry` should be `True`. Note that `neg` and `dry` are mutually exclusive for a given negotiation session.

class asa_locator()

Most ASAs don't need to create such an object, but it will be returned by a GRASP `discover` or `get_flood` function. Its attributes are:

- .locator The actual locator, either an `ipaddress` or a string
- .ifi The interface identifier via which this was discovered
- .expire `int(time.clock())` value when this entry expires (0=never)
- .diverted Boolean – True if the locator was discovered via a Divert option
- .protocol Applicable transport protocol (`IPPROTO_TCP` or `IPPROTO_UDP`)
- .port Applicable port number
- .is_ipaddress Boolean – if True, the locator is a Python `ipaddress`
- .is_fqdn Boolean – if True, the locator is an FQDN (string)
- .is_uri Boolean – if True, the locator is a URI (string)

class tagged_objective()

Most ASAs don't need to create such an object, but it is used by the GRASP `flood` and `get_flood` functions. Its attributes are:

- .objective A flooded objective

`.source` The `asa_locator` from which the flooded objective came

Functions

The ASA can call a bunch of Python functions. Almost all are identical in **graspi** and **grasp**. Here is a summary, followed by detailed descriptions:

register_asa(), **deregister_asa()**

Each ASA must use these to register itself when it starts and to sign off when it exits. Registration returns a handle² that must be presented in all subsequent API calls.

register_obj(), **deregister_obj()**

Each ASA must register each GRASP objective that it supports either for negotiation or as a data source for synchronization or flooding. Registration enables discovery to occur, including assigning a dynamic port. Deregistration of objectives is possible (but is done automatically by `deregister_asa()`).

discover()

This is used to discover peers for negotiation or synchronization.

request_negotiate()

Old API: **grasp.req_negotiate()**

This is used by a negotiation initiator to start a negotiation sequence (with a GRASP Request Negotiate message).

listen_negotiate(), **stop_negotiate()**

An ASA that wishes to respond to negotiation requests calls `listen_negotiate` to start listening and `stop_negotiate` to stop listening.

negotiate_step(), **negotiate_wait()**, **end_negotiate()**

These are used by negotiation initiators and responders to conduct a negotiation sequence, following `req_negotiate` or `listen_negotiate`.

send_invalid()

Abrupt stop after invalid message. Normally, **end_negotiate()** is preferable.

synchronize()

This is used by a synchronization initiator to fetch a synchronized objective (normally with a GRASP Request Synchronize message).

listen_synchronize(), **stop_synchronize()**

² previously 'nonce'

An ASA that wishes to respond to synchronization requests calls `listen_synchronize` to start listening and `stop_synchronize` to stop listening.

flood()

This is used by an ASA wishing to flood one or more GRASP objectives to the AN.

get_flood()

This is used by an ASA to fetch flooded objectives.

expire_flood()

This is used in special cases to mark a flooded objective as expired.

Old API only: **grasp.gsend()** , **grasp.grecv()**

These are additional to the GRASP specification and allow two ASAs to send arbitrary CBOR objects to each other.

All functions return an error code (integer) as their first return parameter. Zero means success. Positive integer means failure. Both **graspi** and **grasp** provide **errors** and **etext** as data. For error code `e`, the corresponding English language error string is `etext[e]`. The error codes have useful names, such as `errors.declined`. Error code details are in [RFC8991](#).

There are also several utility functions: **skip_dialogue()** , **tprint()** , **ttprint()** , **init_bubble_text()** , **dump_all()** .

Registration functions:

```
#####  
# register_asa(asa_name)  
#  
# Tells the GRASP engine that a new ASA is starting up.  
# Also triggers GRASP initialisation if needed.  
#  
# return zero, asa_handle if successful  
# return errorcode, None if failure  
#  
# Note - the ASA must store the asa_handle (an opaque Python  
# object) and use it in every subsequent GRASP call.  
#####
```

The ASA name must be unique within a given GRASP instance. For ASA life cycle support, it could be a basic functional name plus a version number or timestamp.

```
#####  
# deregister_asa(asa_handle, asa_name)  
#  
# Tells GRASP that an ASA is exiting, deregisters its objectives.  
#  
# return zero if successful  
# return errorcode if failure  
#####
```

```
#####
# register_obj(asa_handle, objective, ttl=None,
#              discoverable=False, overlap=False,
#              local=False, rapid=False, locators=[])
#
# Store an objective that this ASA supports and may modify.
#
# The objective becomes available for discovery only after
# a call to listen_negotiate() or listen_synchronize()
# unless the optional parameter discoverable is True.
#
# ttl is discovery time to live in milliseconds; the default
# is the GRASP default timeout.
#
# if discoverable==True, the objective is *immediately*
# discoverable even if the ASA is not listening.
#
# if overlap==True, more than one ASA may register this objective.
#
# if local==True, discovery must return a link-local address.
# (also applies in DULL mode)
#
# if rapid==True, the supplied objective value will be sent
# in rapid mode (only implemented for synchronization).
#
# locators is an optional list of explicit asa_locators,
# trumping normal discovery.
#
# After registration, the ASA may negotiate the objective
# or use it to send synchronized or flooded data.
# Registration is not needed if the ASA only wants to
# receive synchronized or flooded data.
#
# May be repeated for multiple objectives.
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####
```

discoverable = True is **not recommended** for normal use. It is for objectives that do not support negotiation or synchronization. **locators** is intended for such special objectives and is **not recommended** for normal use.

overlap = True is intended for ASA life cycle support, where old and new versions of the same ASA may need to overlap in time. It slightly complicates how objectives are registered and deregistered.

local = True is intended for infrastructure ASAs that must work on-link only.

```
#####
# deregister_obj(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Stops all operations on this objective (if registered)
# by removing it from the registry. (Except for an objective
# with overlapped registrations.)
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####
```

Discovery function:

```
#####
# discover(asa_handle, objective, timeout,
#           flush=False, minimum_TTL=-1)
#
# Call in separate thread if asynchronous operation required.
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default).
#
# If there are cached results, they are returned immediately.
# If not, results will be collected until the timeout occurs.
#
# Optional parameter minimum_TTL (in milliseconds) will flush
# stale cached results first, if non-negative.
#
# Optional parameter flush=True will flush cached results first
# (equivalent to minimum_TTL=0).
#
# return zero, list of asa_locator if successful
#   If no peers discovered, the list is empty
# return errorcode, [] if failure
#                               Exponential backoff RECOMMENDED.
#####
```

Example:

```
obj1 = grasp.objective("EX9")
err, locators = graspi.discover(asa_handle, obj1, None)
if err:
    #error handling goes here
elif locators == []:
    #nothing discovered
else:
    if locators[0].is_ipaddress:
        peer = locators[0]
        # we'll use the first discovered peer...
        # peer.locator is the IP address
        # peer.protocol is normally IPPROTO_TCP
        # peer.port is the port number to use
```

Use of **minimum_TTL=0** is recommended after several failed negotiation or synchronization attempts. Otherwise, no new discovery multicasts will be sent until the discovery cache times out.

ASAs requiring flooded values or mode synchronization need not call `discover()`. See `synchronize()`. Similarly, ASAs wishing to negotiate an objective with any available peer need not call `discover()`. See `request_negotiate()`.

Negotiation functions:

```
#####
# request_negotiate(asa_handle, objective, peer, timeout)
#
# Request negotiation session with a peer ASA.
#
# asa_handle identifies the calling ASA
#
# objective must include the requested value
#
# The objective's loop_count value should be set to a suitable
# value by the ASA. If not, the GRASP default will apply.
#
# peer is the target node, an asa_locator returned by discover()
# If peer is None, discovery is performed first.
#
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default)
#
# Launch in a new thread if asynchronous operation required.
#
# Four possible return conditions are possible:
#
# 1) return zero, None, objective, None
#
# The peer has agreed; the returned objective contains
# the agreed value.
#
# 2) return zero, session_handle, objective, None
#
# Negotiation continues.
#
# The returned objective contains the first value offered by the
# negotiation peer. This instance of the objective MUST be used in
# subsequent negotiation steps because it contains the loop count.
#
# The ASA MUST store the session_handle (an opaque Python object)
# and use it in the subsequent negotiation steps.
#
# 3) return errors.declined, None, None, string
#
# The peer declined further negotiation, the string gives a reason
# if provided by the peer.
#
# 4) For any non-zero errorcode except errors.declined:
#     return errorcode, None, None, None
#
# The negotiation failed, errorcode gives reason.
# Exponential backoff RECOMMENDED before retry.
#####
```

Special note for infrastructure ASAs:

session_handle.id_source will be the IP address of the remote ASA. This is expected to be needed by the ACP infrastructure ASA.

```
#####
#
# Old API version available in the grasp module:
# grasp.req_negotiate(asa_handle, objective, peer, timeout)
#
# Request negotiation session with a peer ASA.
#
# asa_handle identifies the calling ASA
#
# objective must include the requested value
#
# Note that the objective's loop_count value should be set to a
# suitable value by the ASA. If not, the GRASP default will apply.
#
# peer is the target node; it must be an asa_locator as returned
# by discover().
# If peer is None, discovery is performed first.
#
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default)
#
# Launch in a new thread if asynchronous operation required.
#
# Four possible return conditions are possible:
#
# 1) return zero, None, objective
#
# The peer has agreed; the returned objective contains the
# agreed value.
#
# 2) return zero, session_handle, objective
#
# Negotiation continues.
#
# The returned objective contains the first value offered by the
# negotiation peer. This instance of the objective MUST be used in
# subsequent negotiation steps because it contains the loop count.
#
# The ASA MUST store the session_handle (an opaque Python object)
# and use it in the subsequent negotiation steps.
#
# 3) return errors.declined, None, string
#
# The peer declined further negotiation, the string gives a reason
# if provided by the peer.
#
# 4) For any non-zero errorcode except errors.declined:
#     return errorcode, None, None
#
# The negotiation failed, errorcode gives reason.
# Exponential backoff RECOMMENDED before retry.
#####
```

```
#####
# listen_negotiate(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Instructs GRASP to listen for negotiation requests
# for the given objective. Its current value is not significant.
#
# This function will block waiting for an incoming request.
# Call in a separate thread if asynchronous operation required.
#
# This call only returns after an incoming negotiation request
# and must be followed by negotiate_step and/or negotiate_wait
# and/or end_negotiate.
# listen_negotiate must then be repeated to restart listening.
#
# return zero, session_handle, requested_objective
#
# The requested_objective contains the first value requested by
# the negotiation peer. Note that this instance of the objective
# MUST be used in the subsequent negotiation calls because
# it contains the loop count.
#
# The ASA MUST store the session_handle (an opaque Python object)
# and use it in the subsequent negotiation calls.
#
# return errorcode, None, None if failure
#####
```

```
#####
# stop_negotiate(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Instructs GRASP to stop listening for negotiation
# requests for the given objective.
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####
```

```

#####
# negotiate_step(asa_handle, session_handle, objective, timeout)
#
# Continue negotiation session
#
# objective contains the next proffered value
# Note that this instance of the objective
# MUST be used in the subsequent negotiation calls because
# it contains the loop count.
#
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default)
#
# return: exactly like request_negotiate
#
# NOTE: The old API return for grasp.negotiate_step is exactly
# like grasp.req_negotiate
#####

#####
# negotiate_wait(asa_handle, session_handle, timeout)
#
# Delay negotiation session
#
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default)
#
# return zero if successful, errorcode if failure
#####

#####
# end_negotiate(asa_handle, session_handle, result, reason="why")
#
# End negotiation session
#
# result = True for accept, False for decline
# reason = optional string describing reason for decline
#
# return zero if successful, errorcode if failure
#
# Note that a redundant call to end_negotiate will get a
# reply such as errors.noSession, which does not need
# to be treated as an error.
#####

#####
# send_invalid(asa_handle, session_handle, info="Diagnostic data")
#
# End session abruptly (see M_INVALID in GRASP specification)
#
# info = optional diagnostic data
# return zero if successful, errorcode if failure
#####

```

Synchronization and Flood functions:

```
#####
# synchronize(asa_handle, objective, locator, timeout)
#
# Request synchronized value of the given objective.
#
# locator is an asa_locator as returned by discover()
#
# timeout in milliseconds (None for default)
#
# If the locator is None and the objective was already flooded,
# the first non-expired flooded value in the cache is returned.
#
# Otherwise, synchronization with a discovered ASA is performed.
# In that case, if the locator is None, discovery is performed
# first, unless the objective is in the discovery cache already.
# If the discovery response provides a rapid mode objective,
# synchronization is skipped and that objective is returned.
#
# This call should be repeated whenever the value is needed.
# Call in a separate thread if asynchronous operation required.
#
# Since this is essentially a read operation, any ASA can do
# it. GRASP checks that the ASA is registered, but the
# objective doesn't need to be registered by the calling ASA.
#
# return zero, synch_objective    returns objective with its
#                                   synchronized value
#
# return errorcode, None          synchronization failed
#                                   errorcode gives reason.
#                                   Exponential backoff RECOMMENDED.
#####
```

Note – a normal ASA can simply call `synchronize()` without concern whether the objective has been flooded or is available in rapid mode; it will simply receive the objective, if available, by the fastest possible method.

```

#####
# listen_synchronize(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Instructs GRASP to listen for synchronization
# requests for the given objective, and to
# respond with the objective value given in the call.
#
# This call should be repeated whenever the value changes.
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####

#####
# stop_synchronize(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Instructs GRASP to stop listening for synchronization
# requests for the given objective.
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####

#####
# flood(asa_handle, ttl, *tagged_objective)
#
# Instructs GRASP to flood the given synchronization
# objective(s) and their value(s) to all GRASP nodes.
# Checks that the ASA registered each objective.
# This call may be repeated whenever the value changes.
#
# The 3rd parameter can be a single list of [tagged_objective,]
# as per the official API, or a repeated parameter
# of type tagged_objective.
# The tagged objective(s) are in the class tagged_objective,
# so must be tagged with a locator, which is either None or
# a valid asa_locator
#
# If the first objective is tagged with the unspecified
# address, the entire flood is treated as link-local:
#
# - the address in the locator is replaced by the
#   relevant link local address
# - the loop count is forced to 1
#
# ttl is in milliseconds (0 = infinity)
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####

```

The tag will normally be **None**. Infrastructure ASAs needing to flood an *{address, protocol, port}* 3-tuple create an **asa_locator** object to do so. If *address* is the unspecified address ('::') it is replaced by the link-local address of the sending node in each copy of the multicast, which will be forced to have a loop count of 1.

```
#####
# get_flood(asa_handle, objective)
#
# Request unexpired flooded values of the given objective.
# This call should be repeated whenever the value is needed.
#
# Since this is essentially a read operation, any ASA can do
# it. GRASP checks that the ASA is registered but the
# objective doesn't need to be registered by the calling ASA.
#
# return zero, tagged_objectives    returns a list of
#                                     tagged_objective
#
# return errorcode, None           failed, errorcode gives reason.
#                                     Exponential backoff RECOMMENDED.
#####

#####
# expire_flood(asa_handle, tagged_obj)
#
# Mark a flooded objective as expired
#
# This is a call that can only be used after a preceding
# call to get_flood() by an ASA that is capable of deciding
# that the flooded value is stale or invalid. Use with care.
#
# tagged_obj    the tagged_objective to be expired
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####
```

Send/Receive functions

These functions are available only in the old API (the **grasp.py** module) as an alternative to the standard negotiation functions. Two peers can send arbitrary CBOR messages to each other, in support of any non-GRASP protocol exchanges. They are sent within a GRASP session, encrypted if QUADS is in use.

Procedurally, the peer acting as a server must support a specific objective and call `listen_negotiate()`. When a peer wants to talk as a client, `listen_negotiate()` will return with a valid session handle. After that the server can use `grecv()` and `gsend()` alternately. Other negotiation functions are not used.

A peer that wants to act as a client uses normal GRASP discovery for the specific objective and then calls `grasp.req_negotiate()` with an extra optional parameter `noloop=True`. Then `req_negotiate()` will return with error code `noReply` and a valid session handle. After that the client can use `gsend()` and `grecv()` alternately. Other negotiation functions are not used. Whatever value the client provided in the objective sent with `req_negotiate()` will be delivered to the server by `listen_negotiate()`, and could be used as an initial message.

To allow multiple simultaneous clients, the server should spawn a new thread when `listen_negotiate()` returns, and then listen again.

It's a bit complicated to describe but simple enough to use. See the example peers `testserver.py` and `testclient.py`.

```
#####
# gsend(asa_handle, session_handle, message)
#
# Sends over the socket for an opened negotiation session
#
# message is a Python object.
#
# return zero if successful
# return errorcode if failure
#####

#####
# grecv(asa_handle, session_handle, timeout)
#
# Receives over the socket for an opened negotiation session
#
# return zero, message if successful
# message is a Python object.
# return errorcode, None if failure
#####
```

Utility functions:

None of these functions returns a value.

```
#####
# skip_dialogue(testing=False, selfing=False, diagnosing=True,
#               be_dull=False, silent=False)
#
# Tells GRASP to skip some or all of its initial dialogue. Each
# parameter may be True, False or the string "ask".
# Default is not test mode and not listening to own multicasts,
# printing message syntax diagnostics, not DULL and not
# silent; silent=True suppresses all printing.
# Ineffective unless called before register_asa().
#####

#####
# tprint(*whatever)
#
# Thread-safe printing; precedes the output with the
# thread's name and number.
#
# Call exactly like print()
#####

#####
# ttprint(*whatever)
#
# Thread-safe printing iff GRASP is running in test mode
# (test_mode == True). Used for detailed diagnostics during
# debugging & testing.
#
# Call exactly like print()
#####

#####
# init_bubble_text(caption)
#
# Switch on pretty bubble printing via tprint(),
# if tkinter is available.
#
# caption: a string that labels the bubble window.
#####

#####
# dump_all() prints various global data structures
#
# Intended only for interactive debugging
# and not thread-safe
#####
```

Implementation Notes

Ignoring comments and docstrings, there are about 2500 lines of code. Suggestions for improvement will be very welcome. The reader is assumed to be familiar with Python and have a Python 3.7 (or higher) environment available. There is a lot of threading and considerable use of sockets. Important Python modules used include: `threading`, `queue`, `socket`, `ipaddress`, `cryptography`.

The API module is **`graspi.py`**, which is mainly a small wrapper for the core. The core of GRASP, including the old API, is **`grasp.py`**. There is also a separate module called **`acp.py`**, whose API is briefly described below this section. They are not yet Python packages available via PIP. Some test modules are described below.

Everything is in a GitHub repository at <https://github.com/becarpenter/graspy>. The code is under a Simplified BSD licence.

The code is very talkative when running in test mode – lots of diagnostic prints.

Main global data structures and variables (for details, see comments in the source):

`_asa_registry` – where ASAs are registered

`_obj_registry` – where objectives are registered

`_discovery_cache` – where locators for discovered objectives are cached

`_session_id_cache` – where GRASP session ids and ASA handles are cached.

`_flood_cache` – where flooded objectives and their values are cached.

All five of these are protected by locks, which must be used rigorously due to the amount of multithreading involved. Some other global variables:

`DULL` True if running in DULL mode

`_grasp_initialised` Initially False

`_skip_dialogue` True if ASA called `skip_dialogue()`

`_crypto` True if QUADS cryptography is running

`_secure` True if GRASP is secured

`_tls_required` True if TLS is needed (not supported)

`_rapid_supported` True if rapid mode allowed (not used)

`_mcq` FIFO queue for incoming multicasts

`_drq` FIFO queue for pending discovery responses

`_my_address` this node's preferred IPv6 address

`_session_locator` address used to disambiguate session ids

`_ll_zone_ids` list of the host's link-local zones etc.

`_mcssocks` list of sockets for sending link-local multicasts

<code>_relay_needed</code>	True if multiple interfaces require multicast relaying
<code>test_mode</code>	True if module is running in test mode
<code>_silent</code>	True if no output printing requested
<code>_mess_check</code>	True iff message parse error diagnostics are enabled
<code>_dobubbles</code>	True to enable bubbles (pretty printing)
<code>_listen_self</code>	True iff listening to own LL multicasts for testing. <code>_listen_self</code> may be set when <code>grasp.py</code> initialises, for testing within a single node.
<code>_i_sent_it</code>	A hack used to ignore own discovery multicasts when not in test mode – needed to run multiple instances in one node.
<code>_test_divert</code>	Flags used for internal testing.
<code>_make_invalid</code>	
<code>_make_badmess</code>	

Threads:

The main GRASP thread exits after initialisation. Other threads may be active:

`_synch_listen`: This is a class of threads that will be activated by calls to `listen_synchronize`, one for each active listener.

(Note – this doesn't apply to `listen_negotiate`, which listens in-line rather than activating a separate thread.)

`_mclisten`: Listens for GRASP link-local multicasts (Discovery messages and Flood messages) and queues them for handling by `_mhandler`.

`_mhandler`: Handles Discovery and Flood messages. It's separate from `_mclisten` so that the sockets don't get jammed up waiting for the previous message to be handled.

`_disc_relay`: A class of threads activated when Discovery messages have to be relayed to another interface, one for each discovery action.

`_drlisten`: A class of threads activated during discovery to wait for TCP Responses, one for each discovery session.

`_tcp_listen`: A class of threads activated by `_listen_synchronize` or `_listen_negotiate` to await TCP synch and negotiate Requests and queue them for the appropriate negotiation or synchronization listener.

`_watcher`: Keep an eye on things. In the prototype, this makes an attempt to recover from address renumbering or CPU sleep/wakeup. In production code, it would monitor link interfaces, add newly active ones, and delete inactive ones, updating data structures accordingly. It would force a switch to TLS if the ACP goes down, and strictly limit operations when neither ACP nor TLS is available.

ACP interface

The `acp.py` module provides three functions:

`acp.new2019()` : Always returns **True**. Its purpose is to allow the GRASP core to check that it has loaded a recent ACP module. Older versions do not provide this.

`acp.status()` : Returns a security status text. The intention is that an insecure ACP would return **False**.

`acp._get_my_address(build_zone=False)` :

This returns the current global scope IPv6 address that GRASP should use as its primary locator (preferring a ULA if available). If there is no such address (i.e. only link-local addresses are available) it will return **None**.

If the optional parameter `build_zone` is **True** the function returns a second parameter, a list of `[Interface_index, LL_address]` pairs for all valid IPv6 interfaces. The interface index is an integer, not an interface name, to maximise portability between operating systems.

In all cases addresses are returned in the `ipaddress.IPv6Address` class.

Discovery Unsolicited Link-Local (DULL)

This is intended for a couple of infrastructure components during secure enrolment of devices and the formation of the ACP. It should not be used otherwise.

If the **DULL** flag is set during the initial dialogue or by `skip_dialogue()`, the code will operate in a restricted link-local mode. The `_secure` flag will be **False** and most API calls will return a **noSecurity** error. QUADS will not be available. Even if implemented, TLS usage would not be available. The various restrictions for DULL mode in the GRASP specification will be applied.

QUick And Dirty Security for GRASP (QUADS)

This is an implementation of [draft-carpenter-anima-quads-grasp](#), using the Python **cryptography** module. A modern version is needed to ensure that SHA256 is fully supported. (Tested with **cryptography** 46.0.5.)

The QUADS implementation and documentation was significantly updated in September 2026.

Encryption Only Mode

Cryptographic key material must be generated and installed in advance. QUADS currently stores the key material in a file `quadsk.py` in a specific directory (whose path is implementation-dependent). Your GRASP domain will be exactly as secret as

your **quadsk.py** file.

To avoid using QUADS, install a **quadsk.py** file containing only these two lines:

```
key = 'No key'  
iv = 'No key'
```

If you happen to mix GRASP instances with and without QUADS, or instances with different keys, each set of instances will work fine on its own. However, multicasts go everywhere, so frequent "decode error" warnings may appear, since each subset cannot decrypt multicasts from any other set.

QUADS Key Distribution

An elementary way of securely distributing QUADS key material is available, as a proof of concept (so it is a bit clumsy to use). It uses the term "pledge" for a node wishing to join the QUADS domain, i.e. wishing to obtain the QUADS keys. This terminology is adopted from BRSKI ([RFC8995](#)). Running in GRASP DULL mode, the pledge uses EST ([RFC7030](#)) to fetch the keys from a simple BRSKI-like registrar, after which GRASP can run securely in the pledge. Note that a BRSKI proxy (such as **casa-proxy.py**) must be running for this to work. Also, a CASA registrar (**casa.py**, see [draft-carpenter-anima-otp-casa](#)) must be running somewhere in the network to provide EST service. The registrar will initially create QUADS key material, so no separate mechanism is needed.

In each node that wants to join the domain, initially run **casa-pledge.py** which will then use GRASP and EST to fetch the keys from the registrar and store them locally. If this succeeds *and* the node is a GRASP relay node, it will start a non-DULL GRASP daemon, to relay M_FLOOD and M_DISCOVERY messages.

Testing

If you don't have IPv6, you may as well stop reading here. The code assumes you have IPv6 up and running, with either a globally routable or ULA prefix. It will run with only link-local addresses, but then off-link sessions will fail, of course.

Two cases do not work (and should not work):

1. Some hosts have a global scope IPv6 address, and others only have link-local.
2. Some hosts have ULAs, and others only have globally-routeable unicast addresses. (Having both is OK; the ULA is preferred by the ACP.)

The code uses the IANA-assigned port:

```
GRASP_LISTEN_PORT = 7071
```

The code uses the IANA-assigned link-local multicast address:

```
ALL_GRASP_NEIGHBOR_6 = ff02::13
```

You need Python 3 and the code has not been tested on any version before Python 3.4. It will not run on Python 2. (On most Linux installations, `python` invokes Python 2, and `python3` invokes Python 3.)

You need various standard Python modules that everybody should have, and also the [CBOR module](#). `pip3 install cbor2` should fetch it for you. (If you don't have `pip`, see <https://packaging.python.org/installing/>.) On Linux, you also need `netifaces`.

Make a local `graspy` directory/folder containing the relevant `.py` files (especially `graspi.py`, `grasp.py`, `acp.py`), and make that your working directory.

Because of the socket usage in GRASP, you may need Administrator or `sudo su` privilege. On Windows 10 you may need to authorize Python in Windows Defender Firewall.

To run tests on Windows, open `graspitests.py` in the IDLE editor and run the module from there. On Linux or MacOS, run from IDLE or try `python3 -i graspitests.py`. Once it has initialised, type `ASAtest()` at the Python prompt and stuff will happen.

The `graspitests` module does nothing very exciting but it tests many pathways in the `grasp` module. Hopefully there will be a lot of output (many screens) for several minutes, and no Python exceptions. If there are any, please tell me. Sending fixed code would be even better ;-).

The code and test suite are set up to run on a single host that hears its own broadcasts. Also, if the host has more than one IPv6 interface, it will relay its own broadcasts between its own interfaces. That multiplies the amount of output in an entertaining way, but all the relay threads should terminate after one loop. (If that fails, they eventually expire their loop counts or they time out).

When running in a single node listening to itself, the discovery cache ends up

containing duplicate addresses. That's an artefact of the testing environment.

The final part of the test is a negotiation between two threads. The starting point for each negotiator is a random value, and there are a couple of other randomised conditions, so each run will be different, including some error cases. Look for output messages from threads Neg1 and Neg2 (example below).

Do not run this test suite more than once without restarting the Python context; it leaves the GRASP data structures dirty so that they can be analysed afterwards.

`grasp.py` isn't yet structured as a fully-fledged Python package. You could test it as follows: Write your test case as its own Python suite, for example as a file `MyTests.py`. Save it in the same directory as `graspi.py`, `grasp.py` and `acp.py`. The test code needs to `import graspi`. Run the code; when GRASP is first called it will perform its initialisations (with a modest amount of FYI printout - example below). Then the test code can do what it needs to do, starting with `graspi.register_asa(...)` and `graspi.register_obj(...)`.

To get clean printout from the testing thread(s) use `graspi.tprint(...)`.

To get diagnostic printouts from inside GRASP, set

`graspi.grasp._test_mode=True`. (But some diagnostic printouts are commented out in the code.)

When running on multiple nodes, be careful to ensure that GRASP is **not** listening to its own multicasts (answer No during initialisation, which sets `_listen_self` to `False`). I had a problem during such tests because the building switch blocked link local multicasts to 'unknown' addresses, so I had to put the nodes on a dumb switch of their own. If you can't do that, the last resort is to change the relevant constant inside `grasp.py` to `ff02::1`, which is the all-nodes link-local multicast address.

Good switches allow `ff02::13` when GRASP nodes send an MLD listener report (join) for that address. Windows 7 and above, and Linux, send MLD, for example. But badly designed or misconfigured switches might fail to correctly implement MLD.

You can have fun by running two toy ASAs on multiple machines. My examples are called "ASA Briggs" and "ASA Gray" (they both have Wikipedia entries). They negotiate with each other (Gray is the initiator and Briggs is the listener).

They randomize the starting conditions for each negotiation, so any kind of result is possible. Note that if you run them both in separate Python instances on one machine, and tell them to listen to their own multicasts, they will interact correctly in the one machine. The latest version of Briggs can support multiple simultaneous instances of Gray. As with **graspitests**, I would like to hear details of any exceptions or issues.

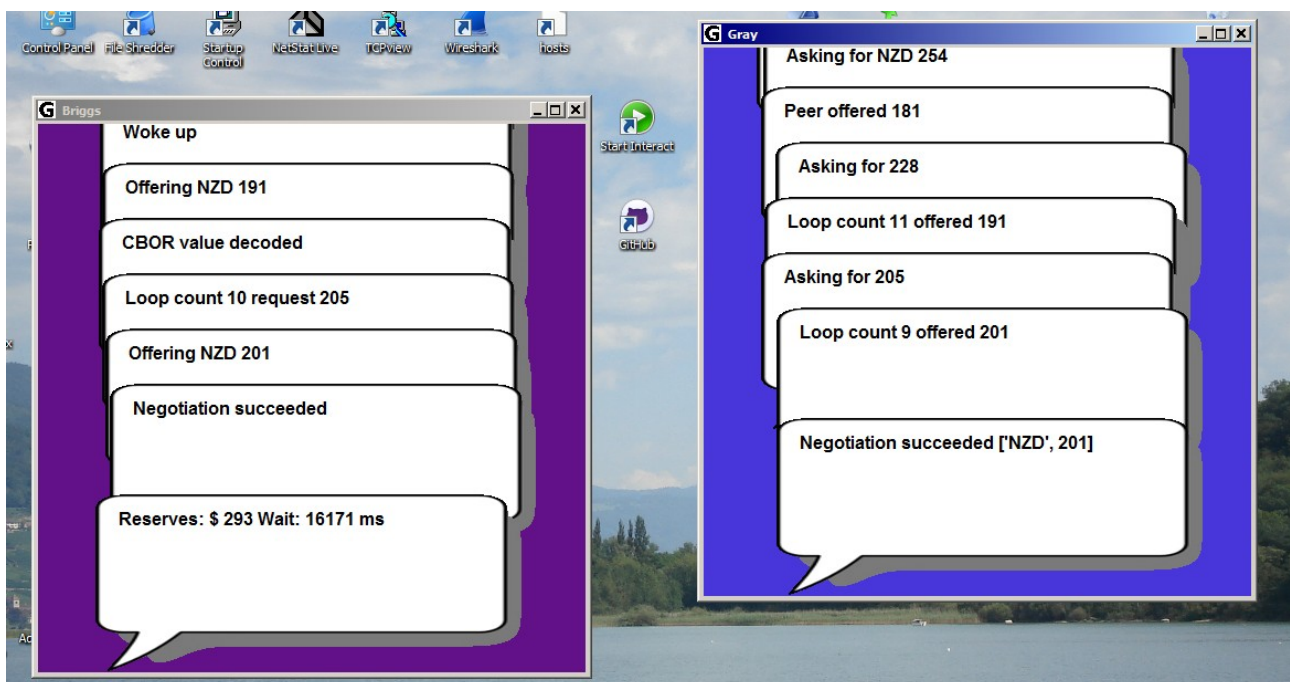
A node that is a GRASP relay with no ASAs must run a plain GRASP daemon. Use **gremlin.py** if you want the initial dialogue, or **gremlina.py** if you want no dialogue. This is not necessary if running **qpledge.py** as described above.

Another sample ASA is **pfxm3.py**. It models the IPv6 prefix management use case ([RFC8992](#)). Multiple instances can interoperate.

Some example outputs follow (they are not from the latest code, so details may vary).

Screen shot extracted from the Gray/Briggs ASA test

(See the pretty bubbles; this might not work on all systems. It uses the `tkinter` package.):



GRASP initialisation example:

```
WARNING: This is insecure prototype code unsuitable
for production use, used at your own risk.
Version 05.0BC-20160503 released under the simplified BSD license.
Starting in 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1
_MainThread 652 Initialised global variables, registries and caches.
_MainThread 652 ACP status is True
_MainThread 652 My address: 2406:e007:56d8:1:28cc:dc4c:9703:6781
_MainThread 652 Session locator: 2406:e007:56d8:1:28cc:dc4c:9703:6781
_MainThread 652 Link local zone index(es):
_MainThread 652 [12, IPv6Address('fe80::28cc:dc4c:9703:6781')]
_MainThread 652 Listen to own multicasts? Y/N
y
_MainThread 652 WARNING: Will listen to own LL multicasts
_drlisten 2908 Discovery response listener for interface 12 is up
_MainThread 652 Multicast relay not needed
_mclisten 1520 LL multicast listener is up
_mchandler 4728 Multicast queue handler up
_watcher 572 ACP watcher is up; thread count: 5
_MainThread 652 GRASP startup thread exiting
```

Sample negotiation output extracted from the test suite

(Detailed diagnostics have been deleted.)

```
Neg1 3356 Reserves: $ 209 wait: 38018
Neg1 3356 listen_negotiate: Waiting for a negotiate request
Neg2 4900 Asking for $ 335
Neg2 4900 Got nonce 2212917
Neg2 4900 Assembled Python message [1, 4417678, ['EX2', 1, 6, 0]]
Neg2 4900 Waiting for discovery response
Neg2 4900 Entering drloop
Neg2 4900 Adding objective to discovery cache
Neg2 4900 Waiting for discovery response
Neg2 4900 Entering drloop
Neg2 4900 Adding locator to discovery cache
Neg2 4900 Waiting for discovery response
Neg2 4900 Discovered locator 2406:e007:59f5:1:28cc:dc4c:9703:6781
Neg2 4900 Sending req_negotiate to 2406:e007:59f5:1:28cc:dc4c:9703:6781
Neg2 4900 Assembled Python message [3, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 6, ['NZD', 335]]]
Neg1 3356 listen_negotiate: Got negotiate request from queue
Neg1 3356 listened, answer EX2 ['NZD', 335]
Neg1 3356 Assembled Python message [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 5, ['NZD', 104.5]]]
Neg2 4900 negloop: CBOR->Python: [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 5, ['NZD', 104.5]]]
Neg2 4900 negloop: got NEGOTIATE
Neg2 4900 Assembled Python message [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 5, 251.25]]
Neg1 3356 negloop: CBOR->Python: [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 5, 251.25]]
Neg1 3356 negloop: got NEGOTIATE
Neg1 3356 Assembled Python message [6, 2260325, 38018]
Neg1 3356 Tried wait: True None
Neg2 4900 negloop: CBOR->Python: [6, 2260325, 38018]
Neg2 4900 negloop: got WAIT
Neg1 3356 Woke up
Neg1 3356 Assembled Python message [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 4, ['NZD', 156.75]]]
Neg2 4900 negloop: CBOR->Python: [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 4, ['NZD', 156.75]]]
Neg2 4900 negloop: got NEGOTIATE
Neg2 4900 Assembled Python message [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 4, 201.0]]
Neg1 3356 negloop: CBOR->Python: [4, 2260325, ['EX2', 1, 4, 201.0]]
Neg1 3356 negloop: got NEGOTIATE
Neg1 3356 Assembled Python message [5, 2260325, [102, 'Insufficient funds']]
Neg2 4900 negloop: CBOR->Python: [5, 2260325, [102, 'Insufficient funds']]
Neg1 3356 Exit
Neg2 4900 Negotiate_step: got END
Neg2 4900 Step2 gave: False None Insufficient funds
Neg2 4900 Peer reject: Insufficient funds
Neg2 4900 Exit
```

Output extracted from the Gray/Briggs ASA test

(some messages omitted)

```
_MainThread 6112 ASA Gray is starting up
_MainThread 6112 ASA Gray registered OK
_MainThread 6112 Objective EX3 registered OK
_MainThread 6112 Ready to negotiate EX3 as requester
```

```
_MainThread 6112 Asking for NZD 498
_MainThread 6112 Peer offered 172
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 448
_MainThread 6112 Loop ct 15 offered 182
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 403
_MainThread 6112 Loop ct 13 offered 192
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 362
_MainThread 6112 Loop ct 11 offered 202
_MainThread 6112 Rejecting unacceptable offer
```

```
_MainThread 6112 Asking for NZD 281
_MainThread 6112 Peer offered 130
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 252
_MainThread 6112 Loop ct 2 offered 140
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 226
_MainThread 6112 Loop ct 0 offered 150
_MainThread 6112 Asking for 203
_MainThread 6112 Peer reject: Loop count exhausted
```

```
_MainThread 6112 Asking for NZD 135
_MainThread 6112 Peer offered 130
_MainThread 6112 Negotiation succeeded ['NZD', 130]
```

```
-----
_MainThread 188 ASA Briggs is starting up
_MainThread 188 ASA Briggs registered OK
_MainThread 188 Objective EX3 registered OK
_MainThread 188 Ready to negotiate EX3 as listener
```

```
_MainThread 188 Reserves: $ 345 wait: 12517
_MainThread 188 Got request for NZD 498
_MainThread 188 Starting negotiation
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 172
_MainThread 188 Loop ct 16 request 448
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 182
_MainThread 188 Loop ct 14 request 403
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 192
_MainThread 188 Loop ct 12 request 362
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 202
_MainThread 188 Failed: You are mean!
```

```
_MainThread 188 Reserves: $ 261 wait: 12774
_MainThread 188 Got request for NZD 281
_MainThread 188 Starting negotiation
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 130
_MainThread 188 Loop ct 3 request 252
_MainThread 188 Tried wait: True None
_MainThread 188 Woke up
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 140
_MainThread 188 Loop ct 1 request 226
_MainThread 188 Tried wait: True None
_MainThread 188 Woke up
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 150
_MainThread 188 Failed: No reply to negotiation step
_MainThread 188 Reserves: $ 260 wait: 11616
_MainThread 188 Got request for NZD 135
_MainThread 188 Starting negotiation
_MainThread 188 Offering NZD 130
_MainThread 188 Negotiation succeeded
```